ERD Subclasses & Superclasses

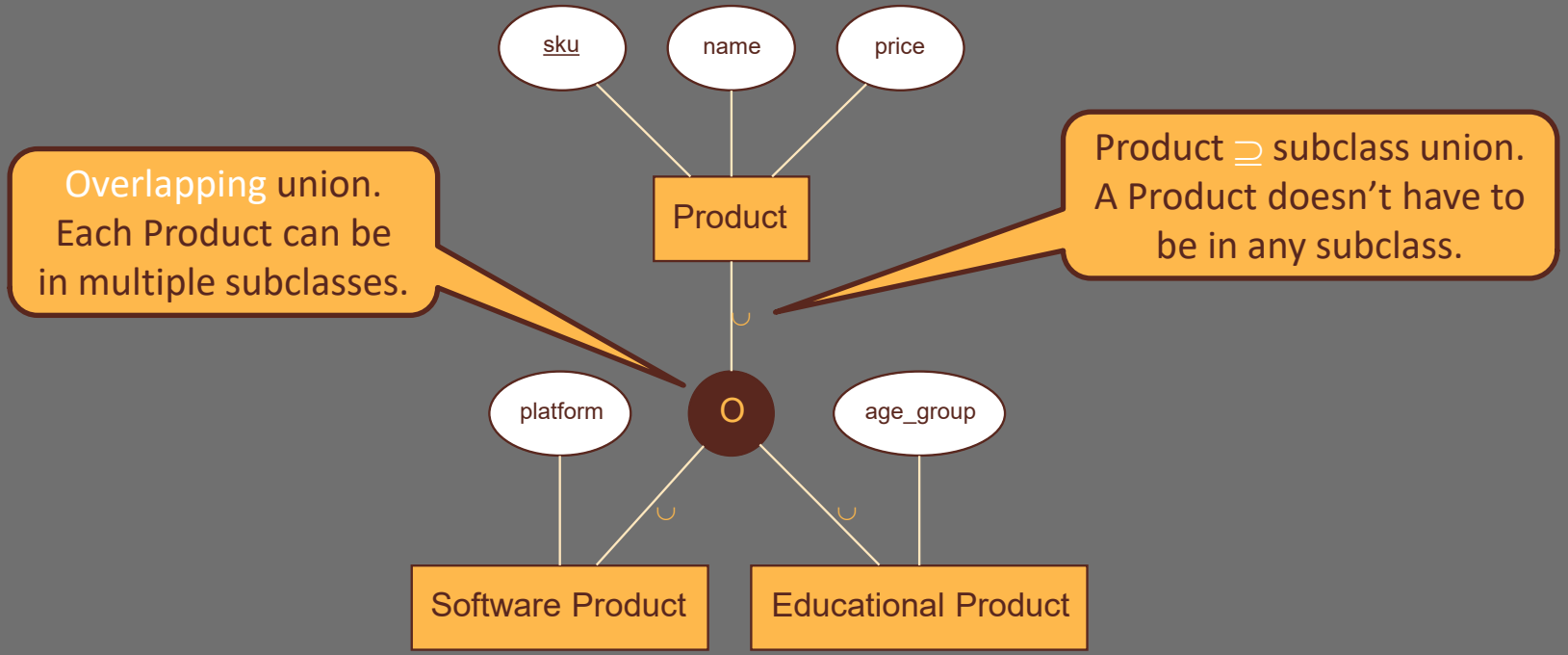
Super-/subclass relation

Entity of subclass is also entity of superclass.

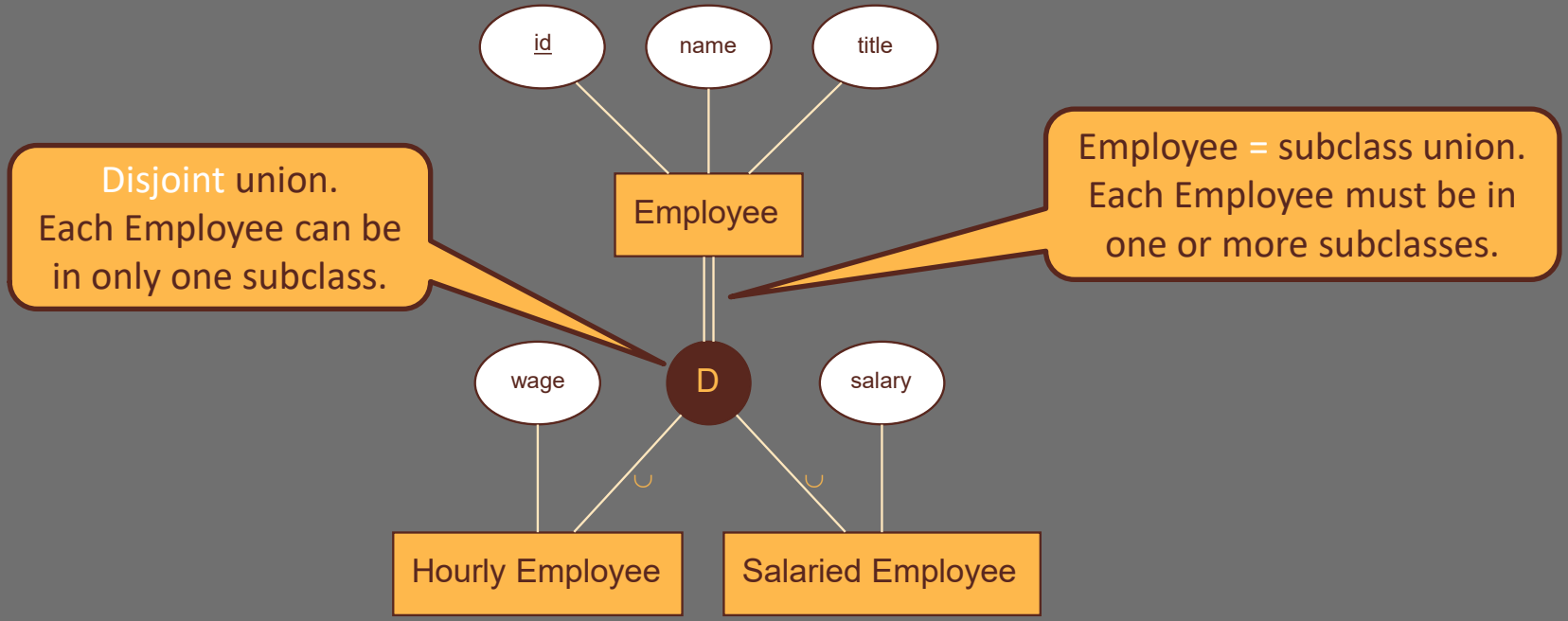
Consequences:

- Subclass entity has attributes of subclass & superclass.
- Subclass is subset of superclass.
- Superclass includes one or more subclasses.

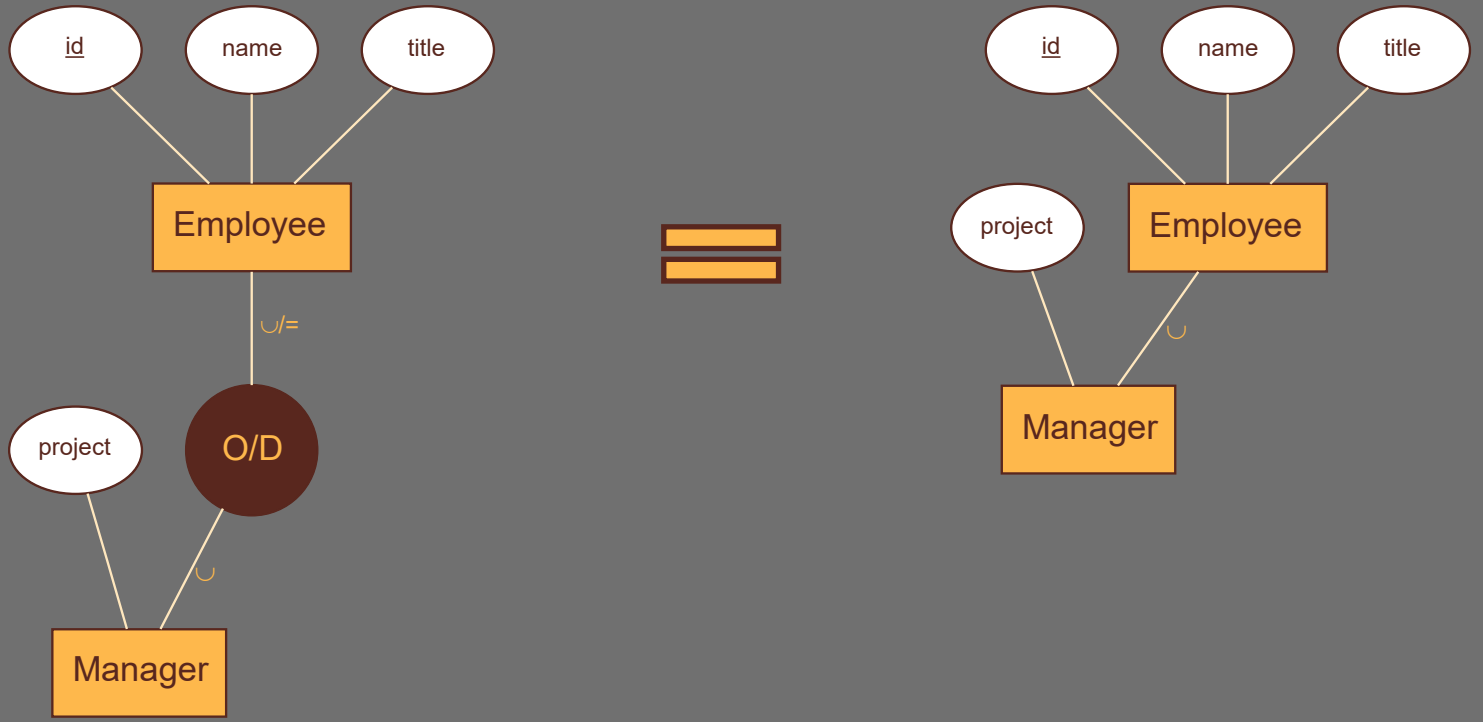
Subclasses: overlapping unions



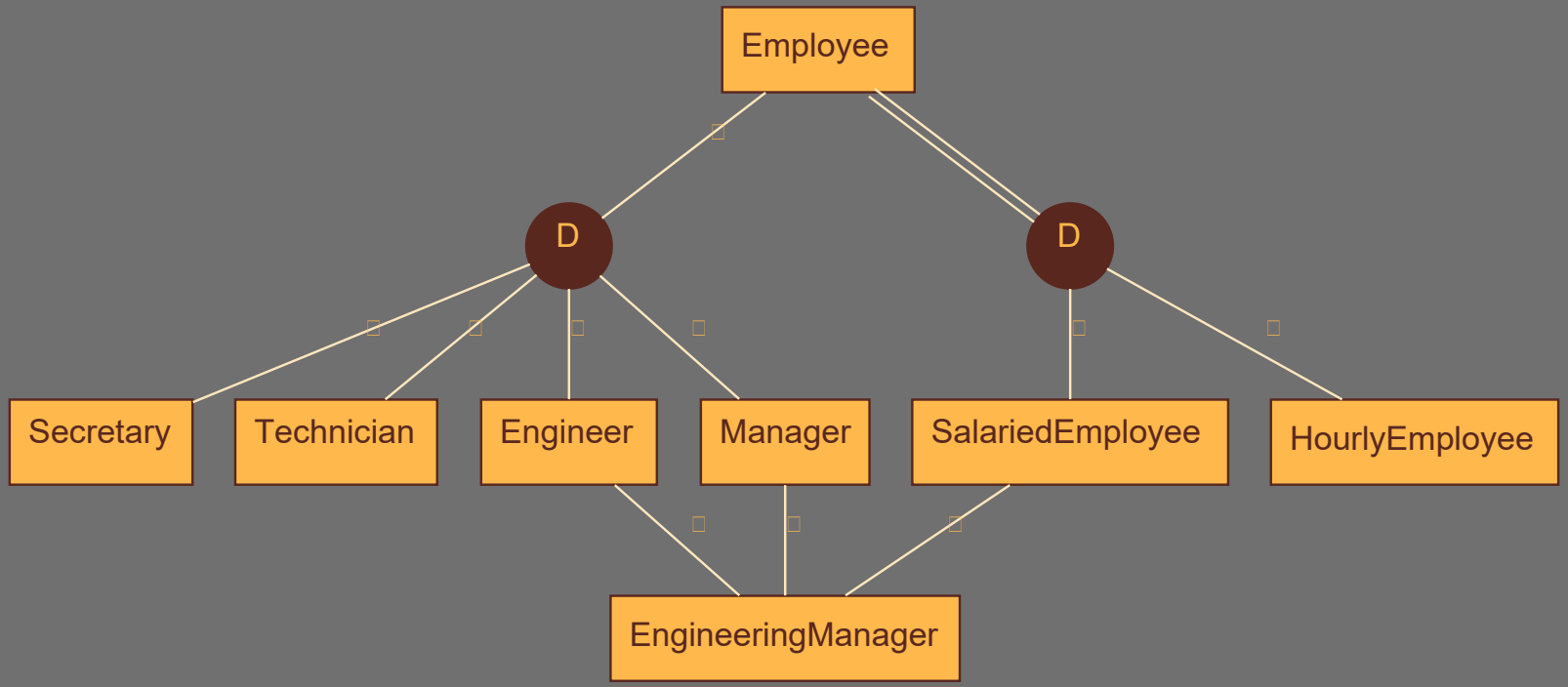
Subclasses: disjoint unions, equality



Shorthand for singleton subclass



Subclasses: multiple inheritance hierarchy



Generalization vs. specialization

Design isn’t created all at once.

- Generalization: ↑ Creating superclasses
- Specialization: ↓ Creating subclasses